



Leader Training Topic:

Nonconforming Items

2025

Nonconforming Items

Definition: Nonconforming items are products or materials that don't meet the requirements or standards *for their intended use*. Non-conformances can occur at any stage of production, including design, pre-production, production, post-production, packaging, storage, shipping, and delivery. They can be caused by quality issues, regulatory non-compliance, production errors, or other factors.

From the Process Manual:

Nonconforming items fall into three categories:

- Scrap
- Returns
- Counterfeit

Scrap

1. Scrap items are normally created from neglect, environmental changes or supply changes.
2. Scrap items are collected in red barrels at the line manager's work area
3. Scrap items will be red tagged and uploaded into the Nonconforming Items spreadsheet by the production line manager.
4. Examples of scrap are:
 - a. Rifle stocks with cracks
 - b. Rifle stocks with uncured epoxy
 - c. Rifle stocks without plastic or aluminum inserts
 - d. Tubes or cones that fail QC
 - e. Expired paint, hardener, epoxy
5. Scrap items are to be **rendered unusable** and disposed of. Disposition is authorized by the Production Manager, Quality Manager, or Business Manager.

Returns

1. Returns from customers will be red tagged by the sales team.
2. Returns are logged into the Nonconforming Items spreadsheet by the sales team.
3. Disposition of returns is authorized by the Business Manager, Production Manager, or Upper Management.
 - a. Scrap - destruction due to defect
 - b. Repair - repair or change the item for return to the customer
 - c. Use As-Is - items that do not meet initial customer requirements but the variation is approved by the customer

Counterfeit

1. Counterfeit items are items that introduced to the supply chain and/or production line that are fake or unauthorized replicas of genuine parts and products.
2. Items that are suspected to be counterfeit are immediately isolated in the business office.
3. Trained personnel will be assigned to investigate the potential counterfeit items and eventual disposition will be determined by upper management.

Quiz

1. What are the three categories of nonconforming items?
2. What is the only disposition for scrap? Give two examples of scrap.
3. What do you do if you suspect an item is counterfeit?
4. Who can authorize the disposition of a return?
5. What stage of production do non-conformances occur?